

Play ball

EL PASO'S Texas League Diablos may not be in the World Series, which begins tonight in Baltimore. Yet there'll be a Southwestern flavor to the series, anyhow.

One Baltimore Orioles' player — infielder Billy Smith — was a Diablo several years ago when he was in the California Angels' farm system. And manager Chuck Tanner of the opposing Pittsburgh Pirates managed the old El Paso Sun Kings three different times.

Even veteran Pittsburgh slugger Willie Stargell played close by in his second year of professional baseball back in the 1950s as a member of the Roswell-San Angelo club in the old Sophomore League.

And, as *Times* Sports Editor John Laird notes in his column this morning, El Paso's "Mr. Baseball," Andy Cohen, managed both Tanner and Baltimore skipper Earl Weaver when the latter two were in the minor leagues.

So, even though El Paso is a long way from Baltimore or Pittsburgh, we may be closer to the action than the miles indicate.